

David Webster

Cloud Platforms and AI Agents

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Hands-on platform engineer and technical lead with 12 years building production software and cloud platforms across GCP, Azure and AWS. I have helped build products and platforms for nine startups and ten enterprises. I started coding on a ZX Spectrum at eight and began learning C++ at thirteen after a Christmas gift. Today I build Python agent systems and cloud platforms, and still write and review code.

Career highlights

- **TMNL:** Led platform engineering across five Dutch banks and reduced infrastructure cost by \$1.5M.
- **LeasePlan:** Built the global AWS platform and completed the migration in under six months.
- **InvestSure:** Solo-built and launched the claims platform in under two months; claims in under ten seconds.

Technical skills

Cloud platforms: GCP, Azure, AWS, on-premises; Kubernetes, Terraform, Aviatrix and Linux

Python and agents: Python, LangGraph, LangChain, Agno, NeMo Guardrails; loop and harness engineering

ML and acceleration: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Numba; JAX (prototyping)

Software and delivery: Go (Golang), Rust, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, C++; CI/CD and test automation

Identity and access: Okta, Active Directory, WorkOS

Data platforms: Kafka, Flink, Spark, EMR, Airflow and SageMaker

Experience

Backbase

Sep 2025 - Present

Principal Solution Architect

Azure

- Lead the architecture for Backbase's new BankOS. Build the shared agentic platform across application and infrastructure layers, including control and data plane APIs.
- Turn recurring product and customer requirements into reusable platform capabilities with security and policy boundaries. Multiple internal and external customer projects are live in production.

Luminis

Oct 2024 - Sep 2025

Senior Cloud Architect

AWS, GCP, Azure, on-premises

- **Gradyent:** Built digital-twin infrastructure with AWS, Kubernetes and Python, reducing compute cost.
- **BuzBrain:** Built the first generative-AI product in under two weeks with AWS Bedrock, Bubble.io and Flowise.
- **ING:** Used GCP, helped build a Kafka/Flink banking platform and trained teams in event-driven architecture.
- Brought TMNL into Luminis as a strategic client; continued leading platform, MLOps and privacy work.

TMNL

Oct 2021 - Sep 2024

Tech Lead Platform Engineering, L6

AWS, Azure

- Built an analytics and model-development platform across five Dutch banks, with a cross-account data catalogue, schema registry and access controls designed to prevent sensitive-data exfiltration.
- Led adoption across data engineering and MLOps teams; redesigned workloads with Spark, EMR and Airflow. Used Go for Kubernetes and Terraform work.
- Owned blue-team work and remediation across multiple penetration tests.
- Helped redesign identity and access control planes using Okta and Active Directory. Implemented controls that contributed to the SOC 2 Type II environment.
- Worked with TNO and Roseman Labs on privacy-enhancing technology R&D, including multiparty computation, homomorphic encryption and federated learning.

Earlier experience

Schuberg Philis

Jan 2020 - Oct 2021

AWS Technical Practice Lead / APN Ambassador

AWS, Aviatrix

- **LeasePlan:** Built the global AWS platform and completed the on-premises migration in under six months.
- Designed and implemented reusable Terraform and Kubernetes migration tooling, enabling development teams to bootstrap and deploy workloads themselves. Stack included Python, AWS and Linux.
- Helped redesign LeasePlan's identity and access control planes using Okta and Active Directory.
- Led AWS practice work, reviewed architecture with teams and shared implementation patterns as an AWS APN Ambassador.

Aame Solutions / ABN AMRO

May 2019 - Dec 2019

Software / Cloud Engineer

AWS

- Migrated legacy IBM Java services to AWS Lambda and built a maintenance tool for secure, real-time configuration and control. Introduced backend-for-frontend patterns across digital channels.

Synthesis

Nov 2016 - May 2019

Software / Cloud Engineer

AWS, GCP

- Owned architecture, core implementation and customer delivery on new product engagements, working with the Chief Disruption Officer and Head of Cloud Consulting.
- Used Go for Kubernetes and Terraform work.
- **InvestSure:** Solo-built and launched the serverless claims platform in under two months. Claims processed in under ten seconds at less than \$500 per month, using JavaScript/TypeScript, CI/CD and test automation.
- **Standard Bank:** Took over a failing personalisation platform and delivered it in three months, rebuilding the event-driven backend with Kafka pipelines and data contracts.
- **Absa:** Built the AWS process engine and trained TensorFlow models for logo and text detection in a delivered brand-audit system.

Paycode

Aug 2014 - Nov 2016

Software Engineer

On-premises

- Shipped Java web services and C++ biometric backends for banking and identity workflows across Guinea, Ghana, Namibia and Botswana. Delivered bare-metal infrastructure, Linux virtualisation, on-site rollout and production support.

Recent software development

- Built and published llm-input-hardening, a Python package with a Rust core that detects and normalises hostile Unicode before it reaches prompts, retrieval, logs or tool arguments. Includes fuzzing, telemetry and reproducible benchmarks.

pypi.org/project/llm-input-hardening

Education and credentials

BSc Computer Science | University of South Africa | 2011 - 2015

13 AWS certifications earned | 5 Kubernetes credentials | TensorFlow Developer Certificate | NVIDIA CUDA C++ and Python certificates